

31% foreign now, 38% by 2030?

A business statement, tested against Eurostat, NSO and Jobsplus data

THE CLAIM

**“foreign residents now make up 31% of Malta’s population”
“...potentially reaching around 38% by 2030.”**

PwC Malta, Summer 2026 Economic Update press release, as posted by Finance Malta, 17 July 2026

The 38% is “the mix of foreign to local residents”, from PwC’s own demographic model.

“Foreign” is not defined in the release; the 31% matches the count of non-Maltese citizens.

VERDICT

NOT SUBSTANTIATED

*31% is right;
38% by 2030 not shown.*

SUPPORTED

LARGELY
SUPPORTED

NOT
SUBSTANTIATED

MISLEADING

CONTRADICTED

MAIN RESULTS

31%

Right for end-2025

Our calculation from Eurostat data, if 2025’s change was within the 2010–24 range: 30.9–31.1% non-Maltese citizens.

32.0%

Higher by birthplace

Residents born abroad on 1 January 2025 (Eurostat). Definitions change the figure.

39.8%

Higher still in jobs

Foreign nationals’ share of registered employment, December 2025 (Jobsplus).

38%

PwC’s own model

We found no Eurostat or NSO projection by citizenship. PwC’s report could not be read.

≥1,610

What about 38% needs

Fewer Maltese citizens a year in 2026–30 for 37.5–38.5% of PwC’s 636,000. They rose every year 2010–2024.

FAIR TO SAY

PwC’s current figure is right, and it labels the 2030 figure as a projection (“potentially”, “around”). This check asks only whether the 38% can be shown from published data.

WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT

- ☐ How “foreign” and “local” are defined for 2030, and whether naturalisations are counted.
- ☐ The base-case local population for 2030.
- ☐ The share at 624,000 and at 660,000 (♦ range known second-hand).
- ☐ The NSO’s end-2025 table by citizenship.